# SPROUT 2.0

## UI/UX Design Case Study

A calmer first step into investing for first-time investors in India.

| 40K | 9K | 3K |
| --- | --- | --- |
| downloads | KYC completions | first investments |

**Assignment focus**

Mobile homepage • Desktop homepage • 5-screen onboarding • Mascot • Accessibility • Performance • Prototype

### Design principle

> Understand → prepare → verify → wait with confidence.

This document explains the decisions behind the interface, not just the final screens.

# 01 — The problem

Sprout is trying to convert first-time investors, not experienced traders. The brief shows that the biggest opportunity is before the first investment: users need to understand what they are about to do, what documents they need, and what happens after they submit KYC.

## The working problem statement is:

> “First-time investors drop off when the next step feels uncertain, the required documents are not ready, or verification appears to have stopped.”

The design response is therefore intentionally calmer than a typical finance landing page. Instead of adding more promotional elements, it reduces uncertainty at each handoff.

## What success looks like

A user should be able to answer three questions within seconds: **What is Sprout? Can I start small? What do I need before I begin?**

# 02 — Evidence & funnel

| Stage | Volume | What it tells us |
|---|---|---|
| Downloads | 40,000 | Strong acquisition reach |
| KYC completions | 9,000 | 22.5% of downloads reach KYC |
| First investments | 3,000 | 33.3% of KYC users invest |

**Important data judgment:** I did not treat every number as equally reliable. The 78% bounce rate is potentially inflated by paid campaigns. The Hindi preference survey has only 40 existing users and does not represent users who dropped off. The 62% KYC drop-off is a strong signal, but its exact causes still need validation.

## Design hypothesis

The most actionable evidence combines the KYC drop-off with support feedback: users are not always prepared with PAN/Aadhaar, and the verification screen can look like the app has stopped responding.

That led directly to two product decisions: **prepare users before KYC** and **make waiting states explicit.**

# 03 — Users & journey

## Persona 01 — The cautious starter

**22, first job / college graduate.** Uses a lower-cost smartphone, wants to start with a small amount, and worries about making the wrong choice. Needs short explanations and a visible next step.

## Persona 02 — The clarity-first investor

**First-time investor from a smaller Indian city.** May prefer Hindi, may not have documents immediately available, and wants to know why information is requested before sharing it.

## Journey map

| Moment | User thought | UX response |
|---|---|---|
| Homepage | “Is this for someone like me?” | Plain hero + ■100 starting point |
| Preparation | “What do I need?” | PAN/Aadhaar checklist |
| OTP | “Did my number work?” | Large fields + resend state |
| KYC | “Why do you need this?” | Clear fields + Why we ask |
| Waiting | “Did the app freeze?” | Progress + time expectation + leave-screen message |

# 04 — Resolving stakeholder conflict

The assignment includes competing priorities. I used the constraints as a decision filter: **user clarity first, compliance non-negotiables second, then brand and marketing expression within the performance budget.**

| Stakeholder | Request | Design decision |
|---|---|---|
| CEO | Minimal / premium; no cartoon | Use a geometric sprout mascot sparingly as a guide. |
| Marketing | Mascot, video, ticker, pop-ups, referral | Keep the mascot; remove heavy extras from the first experience. |
| Compliance | Risk disclaimer above the fold | Integrate a visible risk note into the hero. |
| Developer | 1 developer, 3 weeks, lightweight | Use reusable patterns, SVG assets and restrained motion. |
| Support | Users lack documents; wait feels broken | Add preparation checklist and explicit waiting state. |

This keeps the product visually warm without making the experience childish or performance-heavy.

# 05 — Visual language

The visual direction is designed to feel **premium, calm and approachable**. Deep green anchors actions; a warm off-white canvas reduces visual harshness; muted neutrals create hierarchy without competing with the primary CTA.

## Design system

Primary: #2F6B4F
Secondary: #4E8B68
Canvas: #F7F8F2
Text: #172018
Muted: #66706A

## Typography & accessibility

Mobile body text is 16px or larger. Interactive targets are designed around a 44×44px minimum. Normal text is planned for WCAG AA contrast. Layouts leave additional horizontal room for Hindi labels and longer translated strings.

## Mascot strategy

The sprout is geometric rather than cartoon-like. Four states — welcome, explaining, waiting and celebration — give the product a consistent visual guide without turning the finance experience into entertainment.

# 06 — Homepage

## Mobile

The mobile homepage follows a strict hierarchy: **brand** → **value proposition** → **one CTA** → **risk note** → **proof/value** → **how it works** → **document checklist** → **benefits** → **FAQ.**

The hero uses “Start small. Grow with clarity.” to address the emotional barrier first, then reinforces the practical entry point with “Investing for first-timers, from ■100.”

## Desktop

The desktop design is not a stretched mobile screen. It becomes a two-column composition with more whitespace, a larger hero message and a dedicated mascot card. The same content hierarchy and CTA keep the experience recognisable across breakpoints.

## What I deliberately avoided

No autoplay video, live stock ticker, multiple competing CTAs, stacked pop-ups or unnecessary referral banner on the first visit. Those elements add weight and cognitive load without solving the core KYC problem.

# 07 — Five-screen onboarding

## 01 — Welcome

Reduce anxiety. Introduce Sprout, the ■100 starting point and the first action.

## 02 — What you need

Set expectations early: PAN, Aadhaar, Aadhaar-linked mobile and about five minutes.

## 03 — Mobile / OTP

Use large inputs, a clear resend state and minimal cognitive load.

## 04 — KYC

Make PAN/Aadhaar entry explicit and provide a lightweight explanation of why information is requested.

## 05 — Verification waiting

Show progress, a realistic time expectation and a clear message that the user can leave the screen.

> Together the screens tell one continuous story instead of feeling like separate forms.

# 08 — Prototype & implementation thinking

The prototype flow is intentionally short:

> **Homepage → Welcome → What You Need → Mobile/OTP → KYC → Verification Waiting**

## Developer-friendly handoff

The visual system is intentionally small: a limited palette, repeatable cards, one primary button style, consistent spacing and one lightweight mascot asset. This reduces implementation overhead for a single frontend developer.

## Performance intent

The brief requires the page to remain under 1.5 MB. The design avoids heavy media and assumes SVG/system or one web font, with animation limited to lightweight transforms and opacity.

## Prototype files

The submission pack includes a browser prototype (`prototype/index.html`) and individual SVG screen references. The final design file can be recreated or imported into Figma if an editable design file is required.

# 09 — Success metrics & experiments

| Metric | Why it matters |
|---|---|
| Download → KYC completion | Measures whether the first experience reduces the largest observed leak. |
| KYC completion → first investment | Checks whether improved clarity carries through to activation. |
| Time to KYC submit | Shows whether preparation and form clarity reduce friction. |
| Support contacts about KYC | Checks whether “what do I need?” confusion decreases. |

## A/B tests I would run

1. Preparation checklist above the fold vs. lower on the page.
2. Static waiting screen vs. progress-led waiting screen.
3. Short hero copy vs. slightly more explanatory hero copy.
4. Interview/survey users who actually dropped before KYC rather than relying only on existing-user feedback.

# 10 — Final rationale

The strongest design decision is not a visual trick. It is the decision to make uncertainty visible and manageable.

> The experience tells users what Sprout is, lets them start small, prepares them for KYC, explains the verification state and avoids pressure-heavy patterns. The result is a continuous beginner journey rather than a collection of attractive screens.

## Submission checklist

✓ Mobile homepage — 390px baseline

✓ Desktop homepage — 1440px baseline

✓ Five onboarding screens

✓ Four mascot states

✓ Design system / accessibility rules

✓ Clickable prototype

✓ Case study with data audit, personas, journey, stakeholder decisions and metrics

✓ Risk disclaimer visible above the fold

✓ No prohibited claims such as “guaranteed”, “safe” or “risk-free”

✓ Performance approach documented

Final note: this is a concept created from the supplied Sprout 2.0 assignment brief. Any real-world regulatory, registration or product claims should be verified by the product/compliance team before launch.